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Castellated Syringe Product Label

Abstract

Provided herein is a drug delivery device having a barrel defining an interior configured to receive a composition, the barrel having a distal tip, an adaptor including a ring extending from an inner surface and mounted onto the distal tip and having a plurality of alternating grooves and ribs extending from an outer surface, the adaptor rotatable relative to the barrel, and a film including one or more tabs extending from a surface of the film along an edge of the film, the one or more tabs corresponding to and configured to be received within one or more of the plurality of grooves, the film applied to the barrel and the adaptor such that the one or more tabs interlock with one or more of the plurality of grooves, thereby preventing relative rotation between the adaptor and the barrel.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION

[0001] The present application claims priority to European Patent Application No. 22172374.5, entitled “Castellated Syringe Product Label”, filed May 9, 2022, the entire disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

Field of the Invention

[0002] The present invention is directed to a drug delivery device assembly having an adaptor element mounted thereon and a film to engage with the adaptor to prevent its rotation relative to the rest of the drug delivery device.

Description of Related Art

[0003] When connected to a syringe, it may be desirable to prevent a luer lock adaptor from rotating relative to the syringe. This can be accomplished by heat shrinking a label or other film to both the adaptor and the syringe, for example as set forth in U.S. Pat. No. 10,661,018, the disclosure of which is incorporated here by reference in its entirety. However, such solutions may require heat tunnel equipment, which can increase capital costs and occupy space on a manufacturing floor.

[0004] Further, the application of such labels or films to a pre-filled syringe, following filling of the device, may not be desirable, as heat-sensitive compositions should not unnecessarily be exposed to heated conditions. Therefore, there exists a need in the art for a film or label to be applied to an adaptor and a syringe in order to prevent the relative rotation of the adaptor that removes or reduces the need for heat shrinking. There also exists a need to provide a more secure, anti-rotational connection between the adaptor and the syringe regardless of the application method.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0005] Provided herein a drug delivery device having a barrel defining an interior configured to receive a composition, the barrel having a distal tip, an adaptor including a ring extending from an inner surface and mounted onto the distal tip and having a plurality of alternating grooves and ribs extending from an outer surface, the adaptor rotatable relative to the barrel, and a film including one or more tabs extending from a surface of the film along an edge of the film, the one or more tabs corresponding to and configured to be received within one or more of the plurality of grooves, the film applied to the barrel and the adaptor such that the one or more tabs interlock with one or more of the plurality of grooves, thereby preventing relative rotation between the adaptor and the barrel.

[0006] In one configuration, the drug delivery device further includes a strip extending from the surface of the film, and wherein the one or more tabs extend from the strip. Optionally, one or more tabs are rounded. In certain configurations, the one or more tabs comprise a width and a length, and the width of the one or more tabs may correspond to a width of one or more of the plurality of grooves. Optionally, the length of the one or more tabs is at least half of a length of one or more of the plurality of grooves.

[0007] In certain configurations, the one or more tabs and the film are molded together. Optionally, the one or more tabs are molded separately from the film and affixed along an edge of the film after being molded. The one or more tabs may be co-molded with the film. In certain configurations, the syringe has a diameter of 10.85 mm.

[0008] In other configurations, the one or more tabs comprise a plurality of tabs, each of the

plurality of tabs received within a groove of the plurality of grooves in the adaptor. The barrel may comprise glass, and an elastomeric stopper may be received within the interior of the barrel. The drug delivery device may further include a plug removably connected to the adaptor.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0009] FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a drug delivery device of an assembly together with an adaptor intended to be mounted on the distal tip of said device according to non-limiting embodiments described herein;

[0010] FIG. 2 is a perspective view of a drug delivery device and adaptor according to non-limiting embodiments described herein once the adaptor is mounted on the distal tip of said device;

[0011] FIG. 3 is a partial cross section view of a syringe assembly according to non-limiting embodiments described herein;

[0012] FIG. 4 is a cross section view of a syringe assembly according to non-limiting embodiments described herein wherein a plug has been mounted on the adaptor;

[0013] FIG. 5 is a side view of a syringe assembly according to non-limiting embodiments described herein in which the film also covers part of a plug mounted on the adaptor, said heat-shrinkable film having a dot-line as tamper evident means;

[0014] FIG. 6 is a cross section view of a syringe assembly according to non-limiting embodiments described herein, onto which a connector has been partly screwed;

[0015] FIG. 7 is a perspective view of a label for the assembly according to non-limiting embodiments described herein;

[0016] FIG. 8 is a perspective view of the label of FIG. 7, showing the label rolled up as if applied to the assembly of the present disclosure;

[0017] FIG. 9 is another perspective view of a label for the assembly according to non-limiting embodiments described herein; and

[0018] FIG. 10 is another perspective view of a label for the assembly according to non-limiting embodiments described herein.

DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

[0019] The following description is provided to enable those skilled in the art to make and use the described embodiments contemplated for carrying out the invention. Various modifications, equivalents, variations, and alternatives, however, will remain readily apparent to those skilled in the art. Any and all such modifications, variations, equivalents, and alternatives are intended to fall within the spirit and scope of the present invention.

[0020] For purposes of the description hereinafter, the terms “upper”, “lower”, “right”, “left”, “vertical”, “horizontal”, “top”, “bottom”, “lateral”, “longitudinal”, and derivatives thereof shall relate to the invention as it is oriented in the drawing figures. However, it is to be understood that the invention may assume various alternative variations, except where expressly specified to the contrary. It is also to be understood that the specific devices illustrated in the attached drawings, and described in the following specification, are simply exemplary embodiments of the invention. Hence, specific dimensions and other physical characteristics related to the embodiments disclosed herein are not to be considered as limiting.

[0021] It should be understood that any numerical range recited herein is intended to include all values and sub-ranges subsumed therein. For example, a range of “1 to 10” is intended to include all sub-ranges between (and including) the recited minimum value of 1 and the recited maximum value of 10, that is, having a minimum value equal to or greater than 1 and a maximum value of equal to or less than 10.

[0022] Disclosed herein are a label with one or more castellations, and a syringe assembly

including such a label, as well as methods of applying such a label to a syringe assembly to prevent or limit rotation of a luer lock adaptor present on the syringe.

[0023] With reference to FIG. 1, shown is a drug delivery device **1** of an assembly of the present disclosure. Drug delivery device **1** may include a barrel **2** defining an interior configured to hold a composition, and having a distal tip **3**. Drug delivery device **1** has a longitudinal axis A. Drug delivery device **1** may be a manual syringe, optionally a pre-filled syringe. As appears on this figure, the barrel **2** and the distal tip **3** may be formed of one single element (e.g., plastic, glass, or other known materials). The barrel **2** and the distal tip **3** are preferably made of glass material. The barrel **2** may be sealed at its proximal end by a piston (not shown). The distal tip **3** encompasses a channel **4** aligned with the longitudinal axis A and providing a passageway for the transfer of the composition, either from the barrel **2** to a connector such as an IV connector or an injection needle, or from a vial to the barrel **2**. On the example shown, the outer surface **3a** of the distal tip **3** has a slightly tapered shape.

[0024] With continuing reference to FIG. 1, also shown is an adaptor **5**, said adaptor **5** including a ring **6**. In the illustrated embodiment, the ring **6** is provided in its proximal region with an inner projection under the form of a discontinuous annular bulge **7** extending radially inwardly. The discontinuous annular bulge **7** may be made of a material flexible enough to allow said discontinuous annular bulge **7** to expand slightly radially in the outward direction under pressure exerted on the inner wall of said bulge **7**. Alternatively, the discontinuous annular bulge may be replaced by a continuous annular bulge capable of expanding radially outwardly. The inner wall of the ring **6** is provided with an internal thread **8** distally spaced from the discontinuous annular bulge **7**. The adaptor **5** is preferably made of flexible material such as plastic.

[0025] Turning to FIG. 2, adaptor **5** may be mounted on the distal tip **3** by friction fit, an adhesive, a threaded connection, or other connection known to those of skill in the art.

[0026] With reference to FIG. 3, shown is a partial view of an assembly **101** in which the drug delivery device **1** is shown with adaptor **5** mounted on the distal tip **3**. FIG. 3 further shows a film **9**, optionally a label including one or more indicia, that has been attached to at least a part of the barrel **2** and part of the adaptor **5**. Optionally, film **9** may then be heat shrunk so as to cover and wrap tightly at least part of said barrel **2**, a distal region **2a** of said barrel **2** on the example shown, and at least part of said adaptor **5**, a proximal region **5a** of the adaptor **5** on the example shown. Film **9** may be continuous from the distal region **2a** of the barrel **2** to the proximal part **5a** of the adaptor **5**, and may be arranged so as to cover equal amounts of barrel **2** and adaptor **5**. Film **9** may be made of a thermoplastic material. In an embodiment, the film **9** is made of a polyvinyl chloride-containing material. In an embodiment, the film **9** may be transparent and/or may comprise writing such as for example graduation, brand name, lot number, expiration date, drug code, or other useful information.

[0027] As will be explained in greater detail below, as can be appreciated from FIG. 3, adaptor **5** is limited and/or prevented from rotating with respect to the barrel **2** and to the distal tip **3** around the longitudinal axis A by the presence of film **9**. Film **9** may also prevent the adaptor **5** from translating with respect to the barrel **2**. As a result, when a user proceeds attaches drug delivery device **1** including adaptor **5** to another device or connector, the operation is facilitated and secure.

[0028] Turning to FIG. 4, shown is an assembly **101** with a plug **10** mounted on the adaptor **5**. This plug **10** may be removably mounted on the adaptor **5**, and may limit access to the adaptor **5** before use, in order to protect said adaptor **5** and/or maintain sterility of adaptor **5**.

[0029] FIG. 6 shows the assembly of FIG. 3 during the step of screwing a connector **11** on the adaptor **5**. Connector **11** is provided with an outer thread **12** intended to match the inner thread **8** of the ring **6** of the adaptor **5**.

[0030] Turning to FIGS. 4 and 6, when a user, provided with an assembly **101** with a closed adaptor **5** as shown in FIG. 4, begins the process of connecting adaptor **5** to another device having a luer connection (e.g., an IV connector), such as connector **11**, the user may first grasp the

assembly **101** via the film **9** in one hand to remove plug **10**. The user may then attach the connector **11** on to the internal thread **8** of the adaptor **5**, as shown in FIG. **6**, without concern as to rotation of adaptor **5**, or axial translation of adaptor **5**, relative to barrel **2**. When the external thread **12** of connector **11** is firmly received by the internal thread **8** of the adaptor **5**, the user can be confident that drug delivery device **1** and the connector **11** are tightly connected without risk of leakage.

[0031] Turning to FIG. **5**, shown is another embodiment, in which film **9** is longer and covers at least part of plug **10**. Film **9** may therefore cover part of the barrel **2**, the adaptor (not shown) and part of the plug **10**, optionally in a continuous manner. In such a case, film **9** may be provided with an annular breakable line **13**, which must be broken in order to remove the plug **10** and open the adaptor **5**. The breakable line **13** therefore may act as a tamper indicator.

[0032] Turning to FIGS. **7-10**, shown are an interior surface of film **9** is shown. As above, film **9** may attach to both adaptor **5** and barrel **2** in order to limit or prevent relative rotation between adaptor **5** and barrel **2**. Film **9** may also include a label with indicia, as described above, providing information relevant to the contents of or use of the drug delivery device **1**. As shown in FIGS. **1** and **2**, adaptor **5** includes alternating grooves **14** and ribs **16** along its outer surface. Film **9** includes one or more cooperating castellations (e.g., tabs) **20** extending from the surface **18** that contacts the adaptor **5** and barrel **2** (e.g., inner surface of film **9**). The tab(s) **20** may be placed along an edge of the film **9** and may be arranged so that they fit within one or more of the grooves **14** on the adaptor **5** when the film **9** is applied to both the barrel **2** and adaptor **5**. When applied to the adaptor **5**, the tab(s) **20** engage and interlock with the ribs **16**, similar to locking gears on a shaft. This engagement limits and/or prevents relative rotation of the adaptor **5** given the film's connection to both the barrel **2** and the adaptor **5**. The widths of the tab(s) **20** may substantially correspond to the widths of the grooves **14** to establish a strong interlocking effect. As shown, the lengths of the tab(s) **20** generally correspond to the lengths of the grooves **14**, but different lengths may be used so long as the interlocking effect is maintained and relative rotation of the adaptor **5** is prevented. For example, a label **9** having a short length may be used where the label only extends partially along the adaptor **5**. In this instance, the lengths of the tab(s) **20** will not necessarily correspond to the lengths of the grooves **14**, and will only extend partially along the adaptor **5**. Although six tabs **20** are shown in the accompanying figures, it is contemplated that any number of tabs **20** may be used to engage any number of grooves **14** depending on the design and desired strength of the interlock between the tabs **20** and adaptor **5**. In some instances, only one tab **20** may be needed.

[0033] As shown in FIG. **7**, the tab(s) **20** are molded directly into the film **9**, extending from the surface **18** and spaced apart from one another by a distance corresponding to the size of the ribs **16**. FIG. **8** shows the film **9** as if it were applied to a drug delivery device **1**, but without the barrel **2** or adaptor **5** in place. The tabs **20** may also be co-molded along with the film **9** and later affixed thereto after the film **9** has been cut to size. FIG. **9** shows another embodiment of the film **9** having a strip **24** extending from the surface **18** and along an edge of the film **9**. The tabs **20** are spaced out along the strip **24** and extend therefrom in a direction away from the film **9**. The strip **24** may be molded directly into the film **9**, or it may be co-molded and affixed to the film **9**. FIG. **10** shows rounded tabs **26**. The rounded tabs **26** allow for a greater clearance with the grooves **14** and permit the rounded tabs **26** to be placed slightly offset from the grooves **14** and still function as previously described. The rounded tabs **26** may also be molded directly into the film **9**, or they may be co-molded and later affixed thereto. It is contemplated that the tabs **20** may take other shapes, so long as the interlocking effect between the tabs **20** and the grooves **14** is maintained.

[0034] Film **9** may be applied to the barrel **2** and adaptor **5** in the same manner as described above. Film **9** may be heat shrunk to barrel **2** and adaptor **5**, or film **9** may be provided with a glue or other adhesive along the surface **18** in order to stick to the barrel **2** and to lock adaptor **5**. Film **9** may also be used in connection with a plug **10** in a manner described above. Given the diameter of the adaptor **5**, the film may be used on syringes with a diameter of approximately 10.85 millimeters.

[0035] The assembly may be manufactured according to the following: a drug delivery device **1**

including a barrel 2 for a composition, such as a pharmaceutical composition, may be provided. Barrel 2 may include a distal tip 3 encompassing a channel providing a passageway for the transfer of the composition, and a suitable adaptor 5. In a second step, the adaptor 5 is connected to distal tip 3 of barrel 2, for example by friction fit. Barrel 2 may optionally be filled with a composition before this second step, or after this second step. In a further step, film 9 is attached to at least a portion of barrel 2 and in order to lock adaptor 5 relative to barrel 2, with alignment between one or more tab(s) 20 and one or more groove(s) 14 in adaptor 5, for example by heat shrinking, an adhesive, or other like method.

[0036] In the non-limiting embodiment in which film 9 also covers part of a plug 10 mounted on adaptor 5, plug 10 may be mounted on the adaptor 5 before bonding the film 9, and the length of the shrinkable film is chosen so as to cover the adaptor 5 and at least part of plug 10, optionally in a continuous way as described above (with or without optional breakable lines as described above). In such embodiments, one or more tab(s) 20 are arranged longitudinally on label 9 so as to still align, and be received by, one or more groove(s) 14 in adaptor 5.

[0037] Although the present disclosure has been described in detail for the purpose of illustration based on what is currently considered to be the most practical and preferred embodiments, it is to be understood that such detail is solely for that purpose and that the present disclosure is not limited to the disclosed embodiments, but, on the contrary, is intended to cover modifications and equivalent arrangements that are within the spirit and scope of the appended claims. For example, it is to be understood that the present disclosure contemplates that, to the extent possible, one or more features of any embodiment can be combined with one or more features of any other embodiment.

Claims

1. A drug delivery device comprising: a barrel defining an interior configured to receive a composition, the barrel comprising a distal tip defining a channel to provide a passageway for transfer of the composition; an adaptor comprising a ring extending from an inner surface and mounted onto the distal tip and comprising a plurality of alternating grooves and ribs extending from an outer surface, the adaptor rotatable relative to the barrel; and a film comprising one or more tabs extending from a surface of the film along an edge of the film, the one or more tabs corresponding to and configured to be received within one or more of the plurality of grooves, wherein the film is configured to be applied to the barrel and the adaptor such that the one or more tabs interlock with one or more of the plurality of grooves, thereby preventing relative rotation between the adaptor and the barrel.
2. The drug delivery device of claim 1, further comprising a strip extending from the surface of the film, and wherein the one or more tabs extend from the strip.
3. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the one or more tabs are rounded.
4. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the one or more tabs comprise a width and a length.
5. The drug delivery device of claim 4, wherein the width of the one or more tabs corresponds to a width of one or more of the plurality of grooves.
6. The assembly of claim 4, wherein the length of the one or more tabs is at least half of a length of one or more of the plurality of grooves.
7. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the one or more tabs and the film are molded together.
8. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the one or more tabs are molded separately from the film and affixed along an edge of the film after being molded.
9. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the one or more tabs are co-molded with the film.
10. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the syringe has a diameter of 10.85 mm.
11. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the one or more tabs comprise a plurality of tabs,

each of the plurality of tabs received within a groove of the plurality of grooves in the adaptor.

12. The drug delivery device of claim 1, wherein the barrel comprises glass.

13. The drug delivery device of claim 1, further comprising an elastomeric stopper received within the interior of the barrel.

14. The drug delivery device of claim 1, further comprising a plug removably connected to the adaptor.
